

larger, but it serves its purpose. I also saw some Canon HD camcorders, traditionally Canons are really terrific, but they're costly. They have a new range called "Legria". The Legria HF S100 has a very large lens and a large filter and the sensor is high resolution at 8 MP. The 15x optical zoom should be versatile though and after trying this camcorder I came to the conclusion that its display was better and the image quality was slightly better than the Sony XR100E. But again, no built-in storage and it loses out. Some will argue with the logic of comparing between camcorders with flash and HDD media – but in reality it's not about the media. Sony offers better bang for buck. Samsung doesn't have anything in the HD sphere.

Be sure to use any camcorder you consider buying. Check the screen, its legibility and brightness, the size which should be around 2.7-inches. Also look at how comfortable it is for you to use. Obviously, if you're a large-handed person, a tiny camcorder may not be a good idea, unless you're willing to compromise on usability. Next, use the camcorder a bit. This will give you an idea about the interface. Touch-screen camcorders are generally easier to use since the interface is usually more multimedia-oriented. I also saw Canons HR10 – a DVD camcorder supporting a resolution of 1080i – impressive.

If you're looking for extreme value, then you will have to opt for one of the other recording formats, namely mini disc (DVD) or DV tape – although these are older storage medium, they're still pretty popular and by no means outdated. The only minus point is the consumables cost associated with media – not suitable for those who use their camcorders a lot, for you will eventually spend a lot on buying media. The Canon DC320 is a very decent mini DVD model and best of all it's available for as little as Rs. 21,000 – a good buy for someone looking to spend under 25K. Samsung's VP-DX200I is for the shopper on a shoestring, decent performance and a price tag of Rs. 17,500 makes it a very appealing buy if you're a first-time, non-discerning buyer.

Since I was shopping for one that we could use for our test centre I had a slightly higher budget and opted for the Sony XR100E and I picked it up for 34,500 bucks, tried as I might I couldn't shave anything off the price.

